

Preview of RBNZ April 2026 Monetary Policy Review

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Governor Breman's recent speech suggests the OCR will remain at 2.25% next week. The RBNZ will repeat that it is prepared to look through the first-round impact of the oil shock while remaining vigilant for signs of second-round impacts on pricing behaviour.



 [Read full report here \(PDF 760KB\)](#)

****Date corrected****

25 March speech redux

- Consistent with guidance given by Governor Breman in a recent speech, we expect the RBNZ to hold the OCR at 2.25% at the 8 April review.
- Barring major developments over coming days in the Middle East, the associated commentary – which will include a post-meeting press conference – will likely closely mirror Governor Breman's recent speech.
- We expect the Bank to emphasise that it will not react to the first-round impact of higher energy prices on near-term inflation but that it will respond should there be evidence of second-round effects that might create persistent inflation.
- While the post-meeting statement will present the consensus view of the MPC, the Record of Meeting will likely reflect a diversity of views about the likelihood of second-round persistent inflation and thus the appropriate policy stance.
- The Bank is not scheduled to present revised economic projections at this meeting. However, it is possible that the RBNZ will provide some guidance of the likely magnitude of the upward revision to near-term inflation and downward revision to GDP growth that might be considered in May.
- We think the Bank will aim to balance a desire to avoid a further tightening of financial conditions with the desire to not sound complacent about the medium-term inflation risks that come with an energy price shock.

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